SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL & COLLEGE SEMINAR

Media & Information Literacy

Understanding Media, Information, and Digital Communication

SUBJECT / COURSE	STUDENT NAME	INSTRUCTOR	DATE
Media & Info Literacy (MIL)	Academic Portfolio	Lead MIL Faculty	Academic Term 2026

SPEAKER NOTES

Welcome your students to the Media and Information Literacy course. Introduce the core premise: we live in a hyper-mediated landscape where critical engagement is not optional—it is a baseline survival skill for active citizens.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Explain the core concepts of MIL and define key domains.

Describe the systemic importance of being literate in daily civic life.

Identify, classify, and analyze different historical and modern media forms.

Differentiate traditional push media from interactive digital platforms.

Understand operational architectures and functional mechanics of media platforms.

Assess and systematically evaluate the credibility of information sources.

Distinguish factual assertions from highly subjective opinions.

Detect, analyze, and counter toxic misinformation and malicious disinformation.

SPEAKER NOTES

Briefly walk through these 8 key competencies. Reassure students that by the end of this course, they will possess the technical framework needed to confidently evaluate, rather than simply consume, modern content networks.

DECONSTRUCTING M.I.L.

What is Media and Information Literacy?

MIL represents a unified set of competencies that empowers citizens to access, analyze, evaluate, create, and share information across media modes ethically and responsibly.

Media: Channels of general communication (TV, print, internet).

Information: Data processed to carry contextual, parsed meaning.

Literacy: Cognitive capability to locate, evaluate, and use data.

MIL: Synthesized critical lens for information streams.



SPEAKER NOTES

Explain that MIL is an umbrella concept. Show how it connects Media, Information, Technology, and active Communication. It prevents students from viewing these fields in isolated silos.

THE ABSOLUTE IMPORTANCE OF M.I.L.

MIL goes beyond classroom academics—it functions as a cognitive operating system protecting us from modern, highly coordinated disinformation networks.

- Informed Decisions
- Critical Thinking
- Fake News Prevention
- Responsible Social Use
- Digital Citizenship
- Privacy Protection
- Lifelong Learning
- Enhanced Communication

SPEAKER NOTES

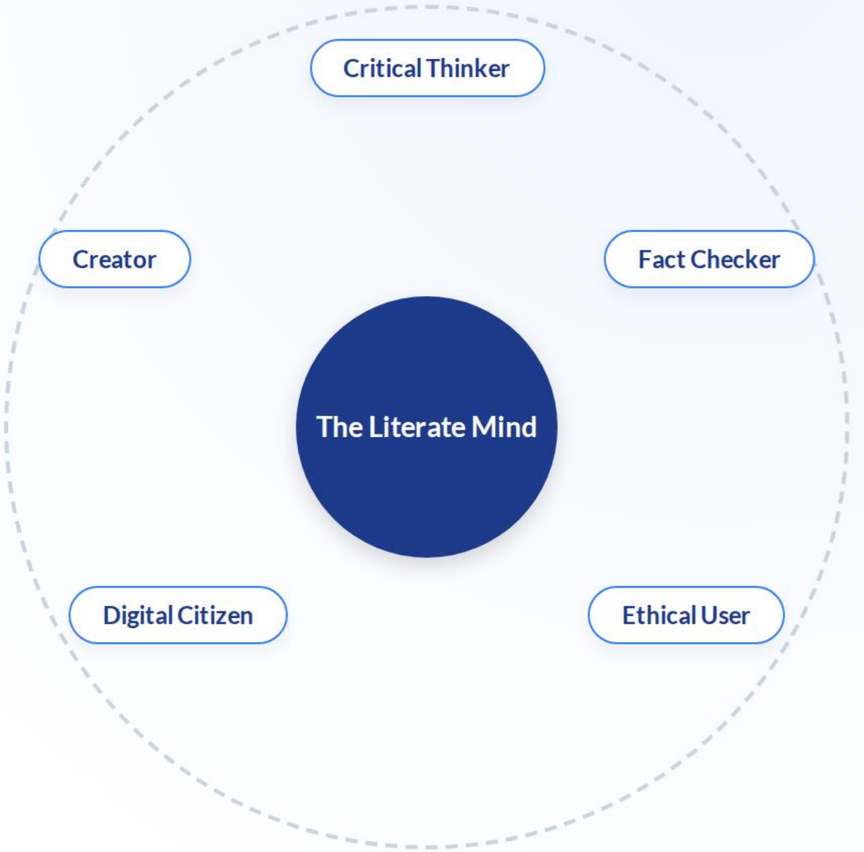
Detail each of the eight points. Highlight how Privacy Protection and Digital Citizenship directly dictate a student's safety, digital reputation, and future professional paths.

CHARACTERISTICS OF AN M.I.L. LITERATE INDIVIDUAL

What makes someone media literate?

An MIL-literate individual does not passively digest streams of content. Instead, they act as active nodes within information networks, constantly filtering and questioning incoming content before sharing.

> *"They verify sources instantly, respect authorship bounds, engage with extreme mindfulness, and deliberately minimize their personal digital carbon footprints."*



SPEAKER NOTES

Explain this wheel model. The ultimate goal is to move from a passive consumer to an active, critical, ethical creator who contributes constructively to the digital ecosystem.

EVOLUTION OF MEDIA TIMELINE

Pre-1700

Pre-Industrial

Cave paintings, symbols, clay tablets, smoke signals.

1450

Printing Press

Johannes Gutenberg. Mass scalable production of books.



1837–1876

Telegraph & Phone

Instant long-distance text signals & voice calls.

1895–1927

Radio & TV

Mass audio-visual broadcasting into homes.

1991–Present

Digital & AI

WWW, Social networks, cloud systems, and generative AI.



SPEAKER NOTES

This timeline spans from human pre-history straight to the Generative AI era. Emphasize how each leap drastically reduced the friction of distribution and speed of delivery.

TYPES OF MEDIA: PRINT MEDIA

Ink & Paper Foundations

Print media represents the oldest formal channel of mass transmission, relying heavily on physical distribution systems.

Standard Formats

Newspapers, academic journals, periodicals, reference books, flyers, and regional catalogs.

Structural Parameter	Traditional Print Mode
Key Strengths	Permanent physical record, trusted editorial curation.
Weaknesses	High cost, zero real-time editing capability.
Gatekeeping	Very high structural friction (editors, publishers).

SPEAKER NOTES

Explain that although print is struggling commercially in the modern age, it remains the gold standard for long-form legal, scientific, and deeply structural reference archives.

TYPES OF MEDIA: BROADCAST MEDIA

Electromagnetic Airwaves

Broadcast media leverages centralized transmitters to stream electronic audio and video data to mass passive receivers.

Prime Channels

Television networks, AM/FM radio frequencies, and public service warning networks.

Broadcast Dimension	Television / Radio Transmission
Advantages	Instantaneous regional reach, multi-sensory formats.
Disadvantages	Rigid programming schedules, one-way passive consumption.
Audience Role	Strictly passive consumer, zero native interactive agency.

SPEAKER NOTES

Note how broadcast revolutionized the delivery speed of urgent national news, but left audiences in a completely passive consuming state, paving the way for the digital transition.

TYPES OF MEDIA: NEW & DIGITAL



Interactive

Users do not simply digest information; they comment, click, manipulate, query, and constantly influence digital paths.



Instantaneous

Zero distribution friction. Information goes global seconds after creation, bypassing typical regional borders.



Decentralized

Any connected node serves as both a consumer and a publisher, flattening conventional corporate gatekeeping pipelines.

SPEAKER NOTES

Focus on how digital media shifted the dynamic. Highlight the concept of "Prosumer"—where every single student with a smartphone is now both a producer and consumer.

SOCIAL MEDIA LANDSCAPES

Platform	Primary Operational Purpose	Systemic Risk to User	Responsible Use Strategy
Facebook / WhatsApp	Social utility networking, instant messaging.	Echo chambers, toxic viral misinformation.	Verify incoming forwarding links explicitly.
YouTube / TikTok	Highly optimized visual video delivery.	Algorithmic rabbit holes, extreme screen dependency.	Cap usage times, check context of claims.
X (Twitter) / Threads	Live, real-time civic public discussion.	Astroturfing, bot armies, outrage generation.	Do not react to breaking news without source checks.
LinkedIn	Professional resume profiling & industry connection.	Exaggerated credentials, phishing scams.	Keep security strict, verify job offerings.

SPEAKER NOTES

Break down the functional classifications of social networks. Remind students that social media algorithms are built to keep them on the app, not necessarily to feed them accurate details.

TRADITIONAL MEDIA VS. NEW MEDIA

Dimension	Traditional Media (Print/Broadcast)	New & Digital Media
Direction of Flow	One-way push distribution.	Two-way, multidirectional, participatory.
Speed & Pace	Delayed (scheduled releases).	Real-time, instantaneous streaming.
Publishing Bar	Extremely high, expensive setup.	Nearly zero, anyone can publish instantly.
Gatekeeping	Rigid (editors, lawyers, corporate owners).	Highly algorithmic, minimal editorial checks.
Examples	Newspapers, analog TV, FM radio.	Websites, subreddits, TikTok feeds.

SPEAKER NOTES

Review this comparison closely. Point out that the lack of traditional gatekeepers in new media is a double-edged sword: it democratizes voice, but also lets misinformation flow freely.

THE NATURE & PROCESS OF INFORMATION

What constitutes quality information?

Information isn't just raw data—it is data that has been structured, curated, and parsed within a specific context to make it useful.

Attributes of Trustworthy Information:

- **Accurate:** Verified and free from basic errors.
- **Timely:** Current and relevant to the present situation.
- **Complete:** Offers full context without omissions.

Data: Raw, unstructured facts (e.g., "102")

↓

Information: Data in structured context ("Patient body temperature is 102°F")

↓

Knowledge: Evaluated data applied to understanding ("This patient has a high fever")

SPEAKER NOTES

Explain the DIKW hierarchy (Data, Information, Knowledge, Wisdom). Show how processing, verification, and critical analysis transform simple data points into valuable knowledge.

SOURCES OF INFORMATION



Primary Sources

First-hand, raw, original accounts recorded directly during an event.

Surveys, diaries, raw data transcripts, interviews, artifacts.



Secondary Sources

Analyses, reviews, syntheses, or commentaries based on primary reports.

Textbooks, peer-reviewed journals, documentary films.



Tertiary Sources

Curated indices, lists, and collections that organize secondary data.

Dictionaries, encyclopedias, search databases.

SPEAKER NOTES

Primary, secondary, and tertiary classifications are vital for research success. Remind students that primary sources offer unvarnished facts, while secondary sources help provide context.

EVALUATING INFORMATION: CRAAP TEST

C

Currency

Is the information current, updated, and timely for your topic?

R

Relevance

Does the source directly answer your question, or is it filler?

A

Authority

Who is the creator? Are their credentials clear and credible?

A

Accuracy

Can claims be verified by other independent sources?

P

Purpose

Why was this written? Is it meant to inform, sell, or persuade?

SPEAKER NOTES

Walk through the CRAAP test. It is a simple, battle-tested rubric students can use on any website or social media post to spot bias or outdated assertions in under 60 seconds.

MISINFORMATION VS. DISINFORMATION

⚠ Misinformation

False or misleading information shared **without malicious intent**. The sender genuinely believes the claim is true.

☠ Disinformation

False information **deliberately created and shared** to mislead, manipulate, divide, or harm a target group or nation.

✓✓ Verification Protocols

- **Investigate source credentials:** Check bios and track records.
- **Cross-verify assertions:** Do other news outlets confirm the claim?
- **Review publication date:** Old stories are often recycled as new.
- **Assess supporting proof:** Look for actual links to primary data.

SPEAKER NOTES

The distinction between mis- and dis- is entirely about INTENT. Disinformation is a coordinated strategy. Highlight verification steps, especially using reliable third-party fact-checkers.

FACTS VS. OPINIONS

Parameter	Objective Fact	Subjective Opinion
Nature	Can be verified objectively.	Based on personal feelings or values.
Evidence	Backed by concrete proof.	Supported by interpretation or emotion.
Agreement	Universal among observers.	Highly debated and fluid.

Classroom Examples:

FACT: "According to regional weather sensors, it rained 3.4 inches today."

OPINION: "The heavy rain made today a deeply miserable, depressing afternoon."

SPEAKER NOTES

Explain that opinions are valuable but must not be confused with facts. Talk about how news channels often package opinions as "editorial analyses," making them look like objective facts.

SYNTHESIS SUMMARY MAP

Evolution of Media
(Pre-Industrial to Generative AI)

Forms & Formats
(Print, Broadcast, Digital, Social)

Information Quality
(Data, Information, Knowledge)

M.I.L. Core Curriculum

Credibility Verification
(Primary vs. Secondary, CRAAP Test)

Cognitive Defense
(Fact vs. Opinion, Mis/Disinfo)

Active Citizenship
(Responsible, Ethical Media Creation)

SPEAKER NOTES

Review the full scope of our study. Show how these 6 key areas connect back to the primary central hub of Media and Information Literacy.

INTERACTIVE CLASS CHALLENGES

1

Defining MIL

In your own words, explain how MIL functions as a cognitive safety filter.

2

Print Checklist

List three physical print media formats and rank their historical trustworthiness.

3

Mis- vs. Dis-

Give a real-world example of harmless misinformation vs. toxic disinformation.

4

Literate Mind

Identify the single most important trait of a truly media-literate creator.

5

CRAAP Test

Why is understanding the "Purpose" of a website vital for spotting deep-rooted bias?

SPEAKER NOTES

Use these 5 prompts to spark classroom debate. Let students work in small groups and share their answers on the board.

MIL KNOWLEDGE CHECK

1. What is the fundamental difference between Misinformation and Disinformation?

A) Accuracy
B) Intent to deceive
C) Visual design
D) Speed

2. Who invented the movable-type mechanical printing press in 1450?

A) Samuel Morse
B) Guglielmo Marconi
C) Johannes Gutenberg
D) Tim Berners-Lee

3. In the CRAAP test rubric, what does the letter "A" represent?

A) Accuracy & Authority
B) Access & Archive
C) Abstract & Active
D) Algorithm & Age

4. Which of the following is considered an authentic primary source?

A) Encyclopedia article
B) Original survey raw data
C) Course textbook
D) Wikipedia biography

SPEAKER ANSWERS

Answer Key: 1 (B) Intent to deceive; 2 (C) Johannes Gutenberg; 3 (A) Accuracy & Authority; 4 (B) Original survey raw data. Give students 5 minutes to complete these questions.

END OF SEMINAR BLOCK

Thank You!

Let's build a highly analytical, critical, and ethical digital community.

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SPEAKER NOTES

Conclude the presentation, answer questions, and open the floor for open debate or portfolio discussions.

IMAGE SOURCES



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